

# Sarah Jade Pratt

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Dual American-Canadian citizen

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## SUMMARY

Software engineer and human-computer interaction researcher with 3+ years shipping production SaaS, now completing an MSc in HCI at SFU. My career spans embedded audio systems, full-stack web development, large-scale government case management, and formal user research — a range that has made me precise about engineering quality and rigorous about understanding the people who use what I build. I'm returning to full-time industry in August 2026, interested in roles where craft, curiosity, and care for the end user are deeply valued.

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## EXPERIENCE

### Software Developer · RedMane Technology LLC

Feb 2021 – Jun 2024

*Production SaaS · Government & social-service case management · Burnaby, BC*

- Owned delivery of large-scale case management features across multi-year government contracts, improving workflow efficiency and data integrity for thousands of end users.
- Collaborated closely with PMs, designers, and non-technical program leads to translate ambiguous stakeholder requirements into clean, maintainable implementations — balancing velocity with long-term code quality.
- Diagnosed and resolved a critical production outage under pressure, strengthening debugging and systems-thinking skills and improving on-call documentation to prevent recurrence.

### Graduate Research Assistant · Simon Fraser University — Tangent Lab

Sep 2024 – Aug 2026

*Supervised by Dr. Lawrence Kim · Tangible user interfaces, embodied interaction, collaborative and directional audio systems*

- Leading end-to-end development of a novel embodied directional-audio system, implementing full ROS/MoveIt/RViz pipelines for gestural interaction and motion planning; contributing toward an upcoming peer-reviewed submission.
- Designed, planned, and conducted multiple user studies, including user elicitation, need-finding, and semi-structured interviews, analyzing qualitative and quantitative data — demonstrating ability to ground engineering decisions in real user behavior.

### Acoustic Software Developer Intern · BlackBerry QNX

May 2019 – Dec 2019

- Built test frameworks for embedded voice-enhancement algorithms integrating voice transcription services; created data visualizations to surface performance insights for engineering and product teams.

### Teaching Assistant (Head TA & TA) · Simon Fraser University

Sep 2024 – May 2026

*Intro to Computing Science (185+ students) · Social Issues & Communication in CS (200+ students)*

- Evaluated 1,100+ written and oral assignments across two courses; built custom grading automation scripts that reduced turnaround time and improved feedback consistency.
- Mentored students in technical writing, ethical argumentation, algorithmic reasoning, and Python — developing strong skills in communicating complex ideas clearly to varied audiences.

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## EDUCATION

### MSc, Computing Science · Simon Fraser University

Sep 2024 – Aug 2026

*HCI focus · Supervised by Dr. Lawrence Kim · Relevant coursework: Machine Learning (A+), Natural Language Processing (A+), Advanced Human-Computer Interaction (A+)*

### BA, Computer Science · University of British Columbia

Sep 2016 – May 2020

*Minor in Applied Music Technology · Dean's List all eligible years · Outstanding International Student Award (\$8,000)*

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## SELECTED HIGHLIGHTS

### MILA Hackathon Finalist — Safer AI for Youth Mental Health w/ Bell Canada, Kids Help Phone

Mar 2026

Finalist and prize winner at national MILA hackathon in Montreal; built and pitched an AI safety product for youth under time pressure.

### ACM UIST Student Innovation Contest Finalist — SyncFeel

Sep 2025

Presented wearable rhythm stimulation system for attention enhancement at a top-tier HCI venue in Busan, South Korea. DOI: [dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3746058.3758974](https://doi.org/10.1145/3746058.3758974)

### Published paper: Human vs. AI Assessment of Student Writing

Apr 2026

Paper accepted and presented at the Western Canadian Conference on Computing Education, including reviewership service.